General was full of appreciation for all that India had done in support of Myanmar. I sensed, yet again, that Myanmar wanted much more from India; that they wanted to break free from the shackles that bound them to China. However, before doing so, they had to be certain that India would stick by them through thick and thin, as had China, who had even used their veto power to scuttle an anti-Myanmar resolution in the UN Security Council.

That was all in the past and it was now time to get back to serious soldiering. While I was away on this diplomatic assignment, the case for the raising of two additional Divisions had been approved and the GSL issued. Accordingly, two new Divisions, 56 Infantry Division and 72 Infantry Division, were to be raised, commencing from 2009. The raising plan had been carefully and practically worked out. First, one Brigade of the new Division would be raised under the wings of an existing Division, which would give them the requisite administrative support. The following year, the Divisional HQ and the HQ units, viz. engineers, signals, medical, etc., and the second Brigade would be raised. For this, the first Brigade, now fully operational, would be the foundation. In the third year, the last Brigade would get raised, following which the entire Division would become ready for operations. 46 Infantry Brigade was the first Brigade to be raised for 71 Infantry Division, under the watchful eye of HQ 5 Mountain Division at Tenga.

I was still in Myanmar when I received my promotion-cum-posting order to take over command of 106 Infantry Brigade, but it did not ring a bell. When I asked my two Army colleagues in the Defence Wing, they too did not know of it. I rang up MI (FD) and again drew a blank, except that the nearest railway station (NRS) was Guwahati. I was one step closer to solving the mystery. That meant I would be moving Eastwards again.

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